PHASE 8

Troubleshooting, Design and Extension

Fixes for common problems, accessibility notes and extension guidance

COMICCRAFT • AI COMIC STORY CREATOR • TECHNICAL DOCUMENTATION

1. Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
“python” not recognised	Install Python 3.10+ and tick Add Python to PATH, then reopen the terminal.
“ComicCraft is not configured yet”	GEMINI_API_KEY is missing from .env; add it and restart the server.
“Your Gemini API key was rejected”	Regenerate the key in Google AI Studio and confirm the API is enabled.
“The configured model is unavailable”	Change GEMINI_OUTLINE_MODEL / GEMINI_STORY_MODEL to a model your key can access.
Stable Diffusion could not be loaded	Install torch/diffusers, free memory, or set IMAGE_PROVIDER=huggingface_api.
CUDA out of memory	Lower IMAGE_WIDTH/IMAGE_HEIGHT to 384, reduce IMAGE_STEPS, or set IMAGE_DEVICE=cpu.
PDF export failed	Confirm fpdf2 is installed and static/exports/ is writable.
Address already in use	uvicorn app.main:app --reload --port 8001
Static files 404	Start Uvicorn from the project root so static/ and templates/ resolve.

2. Design & Accessibility Notes

- Mobile-first CSS with breakpoints at 375 / 480 / 768 / 1024 / 1280 / 1440 px; no horizontal overflow at 320 px.
- Comic grid: one column on mobile, two columns from 768 px, with the final odd panel centred full-width.
- Semantic HTML, labelled controls, role="radiogroup" selection groups with arrow-key navigation, visible focus rings, alt text and full prefers-reduced-motion support.
- Toasts replace alert(); inline field errors replace browser-default validation bubbles.

3. Extending the Application

The service layer is intentionally modular:

- Add a new class to image_generator.py and register it in _PROVIDERS to swap illustration backends.
- Swap text models through .env alone — no code changes required.
- Persistence for user profiles, comic libraries and multi-page story arcs can be added behind comic_service.create_comic without touching routes or templates.

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